

Book Nook User Guide
Group 12 COSC 360 Final Project
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1. Introduction

Book Nook is a web-based virtual library and book exchange platform designed to help users discover, share, and exchange books with others. The platform allows anyone to browse a catalog of book listings, and registered users can list their own books, manage their listings, and participate in discussions on listing pages.

The site supports three levels of access. Guests can browse and search all book listings without an account, or create an account to access registered user features. Registered users can post and manage their own listings and profile, comment in discussion threads, and message other registered users. Admins have additional tools to search for and manage users and listings across the platform.

This guide walks through how to access the site, create an account, and use its features depending on your role.

2. Getting Started

Book Nook is containerized using Docker, so no manual installation is required. To run the site locally:

1. Ensure Docker Desktop is installed and running on your machine
2. Clone the project repository from GitHub
3. From the root of the repository, run: `docker compose up --build`
4. Once all services have started, open your browser and navigate to <http://localhost:4000>

The site is fully self-contained, the frontend, backend, and database all start together automatically.

An admin account is created automatically when the application starts. To log in as an admin, use the following credentials:

Email: admin@admin.com

Password: `apassword`

These credentials can be changed via the `‘/backend/.env’` file if needed.

To test registered user features, register a new account from the Register page. No email verification is required, the account will be active immediately after registration.

To stop the application, press (Ctrl+C) in the terminal where it is running, then run:
`docker compose down`

To stop the application and clear all database data for a completely fresh start, run:
`docker compose down -v`

3. Walkthrough

a. as an Unregistered User

i. Browsing Listings

1. From the home page, type a book title into the search bar and press Enter. You will be taken to the Browse page showing matching listings.
2. Alternatively, click Browse in the navigation bar to view all listings without a search term, or use the explore options at the bottom of the homepage to see all listings of a particular genre.
3. Click on any listing to view its full details, including title, genre, format, and description.

ii. Creating an Account

1. Click Register in the navigation bar.
2. Fill in your name, email address, password, and optionally upload a profile picture.
3. Click Create Account.

b. as a Registered User

i. Logging In

1. Click Login in the navigation bar and enter your email and password.

ii. Managing Your Profile

1. Click Profile in the navigation bar to view your account details and profile picture.
2. Click Edit Profile, and fill in the required details, submit, then see the changes reflected immediately in your profile page.

iii. Browsing and Creating Listings

1. Navigate to the Browse page using the navigation bar, or search from the home page. All available book listings should be displayed.
2. To post a book, click Make a Listing in the navigation bar.
3. Enter the book's title, genre, format (Paperback, Hardcover, or Mass Market Paperback), and an optional description, then click Submit. The listing will appear in the Browse page immediately after submission and is stored in the database.
4. To view a listing's full details, click on the title from the Browse page.

iv. Managing Your Listings

1. On the Browse page, listings you have created will display Edit and Delete buttons.
2. To mark a listing as reserved,

3. Click Edit to update a listing's details and submit your changes.
 4. Click Delete and Confirm to permanently remove a listing.
- v. Comment Threads
1. Click on any listing from the Browse page to open its detail page.
 2. To post a comment, type your message in the comment box and click Post Comment.
 3. To reply to an existing comment, click Reply under that comment, type your message, and click Post Reply.
 4. To delete one of your own comments, click the Delete button on it. The comment will be greyed out, the username will be replaced with "Deleted comment", and the comment text will be replaced with "This comment was deleted."
- vi. Messaging/Reservation
1. While viewing another account's post, click "Message to reserve book", and type, then send a message.
 2. From the account that owns the post, click the Messages header to see a new message, send a response, and mark the listing as reserved for that user.
- c. as an Administrator
- i. Searching for Listings
1. From the home page, use the Search Listings By Name bar to search for listings by title.
 2. Alternatively, use the Find Listing By ID bar to look up a specific listing by its database ID and navigate directly to its detail page.
- ii. Searching for Users
1. Use the Search Users By Name bar to find a user by their display name.
 2. Alternatively, use the Search Users By Email bar to find a user by their email address. Note that this field requires a valid email format.
 3. Both searches will take you to a user profile page displaying that user's details.
- iii. Managing Users and Listings
1. Click the Delete button underneath any listing belonging to the logged in account to permanently remove the listing.
 2. To delete a user, navigate to their profile page, and click the Delete button to permanently remove their account.
- iv. Analytics
1. Click the Admin Links header, then select analytics to see some usage data.